

General Knowledge

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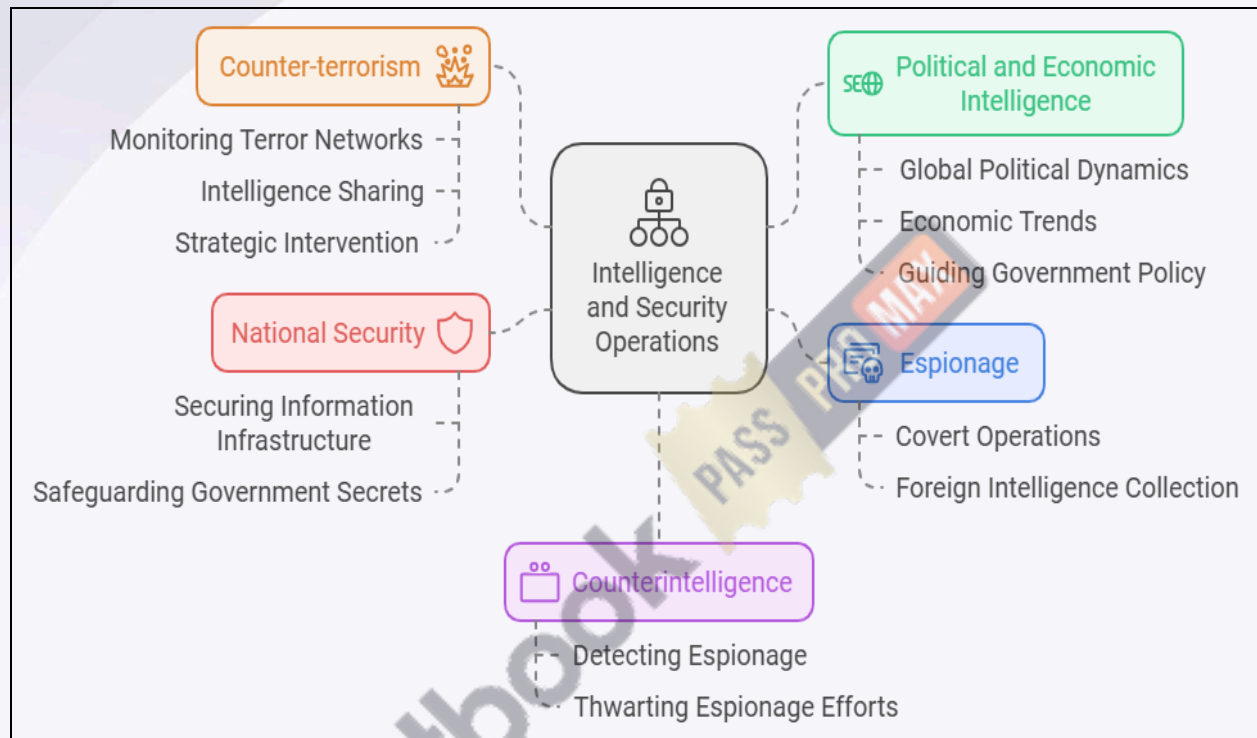
STUDY NOTES

Intelligence Agencies



Intelligence Agencies

Intelligence agencies are specialized government organizations responsible for gathering, analyzing, and protecting information critical to a nation's security. Their primary purposes include:



Some important Intelligence Agencies of the World

Intelligence Agency	Country	Primary Role	Unique Features
Central Intelligence Agency (CIA)	USA	Foreign intelligence and covert operations	A vast network of operatives, a significant influence on U.S. foreign policy
MI6 (Secret Intelligence Service)	UK	Foreign intelligence and espionage	High-profile espionage during WWII and the Cold War, close collaboration with the CIA

Federal Security Service (FSB)	Russia	Counter-intelligence, counter-terrorism, and foreign intelligence	Successor to KGB's domestic operations, significant influence over Russian society
Research and Analysis Wing (RAW)	India	Foreign intelligence, especially regarding Pakistan, China, and neighbouring countries	Securing India's interests in South Asia operates with little public oversight
Mossad	Israel	Foreign intelligence, covert operations, and counter-terrorism	Bold and high-risk missions, effective and secretive
Directorate-General for External Security (DGSE)	France	Foreign intelligence and counter-terrorism	Extensive network in North and West Africa, focus on counter-terrorism and international threats
Ministry of State Security (MSS)	China	Foreign and counterintelligence	Extensive use of cyber espionage, gathering information on global targets
Bundesnachrichtendienst (BND)	Germany	Foreign intelligence gathering and analysis	Monitors global communications and provides insights on international threats

Central Intelligence Agency (CIA), USA

- The Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) is the civilian foreign intelligence service of the United States government.
- Its primary mission is to gather, process, and analyze global national security information, mainly through human intelligence.
- The CIA's headquarters is located in Langley, McLean, Virginia.
- The agency was established on September 18, 1947, by President Harry S. Truman.

- It plays a crucial role in supporting U.S. national security by providing vital intelligence.

Important missions or operations

Operation/Mission	Organization	Details
Operation Ajax (1953)	CIA, MI6, Iran	A covert operation to overthrow Iran's Prime Minister Mohammad Mossadegh and reinstate the Shah of Iran. The CIA orchestrated a coup by manipulating public opinion, creating unrest, and working with Iranian military officials.
Operation Mongoose (1961-1962)	CIA, US Government	A covert operation aimed at undermining and destabilizing Fidel Castro's Cuban regime through sabotage, assassination attempts, and support for anti-Castro groups.
Operation Phoenix (1967-1972)	CIA, South Vietnam	A controversial counterinsurgency program during the Vietnam War aimed to neutralize the Viet Cong by infiltrating and targeting its leadership, using intelligence gathered through covert means, including assassination, arrests, and other methods.
The Killing of Osama bin Laden (2011)	CIA, US Navy SEALs	A highly secretive mission, the CIA coordinated intelligence to track down Osama bin Laden, the leader of Al-Qaeda, eventually leading to his killing by Navy SEALs in Abbottabad, Pakistan.
Operation CHAOS (1967-1974)	CIA	A covert program aimed at monitoring and infiltrating anti-Vietnam War and other left-wing activist groups in the U.S., especially those opposing U.S. military involvement in Southeast Asia.
Operation Gladio (Cold War)	CIA, NATO, European Intelligence Services	A secret program involving the CIA and NATO forces to create stay-behind networks in Western Europe to counter potential Soviet invasions and communist uprisings, sometimes involving covert operations and sabotage.

The Cuban Missile Crisis (1962)	CIA, US Government	The CIA played a key role in detecting Soviet missiles in Cuba, which led to the 13-day standoff between the US and the Soviet Union, nearly causing nuclear war. The intelligence gathered by the CIA was pivotal in negotiating a peaceful resolution.
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Federal Security Service, USSR

- The Federal Security Service (FSS) of the Russian Federation, formerly known as the KGB, was established on April 12, 1995.
- It is currently led by Director Alexander Bortnikov.
- The FSS is responsible for counter-intelligence, investigative operations, border security, and protecting the leadership of the Soviet government and the Communist Party.
- Its headquarters are located at 24 Kuznetsky Most Street, Moscow, Russia.

Important missions or operations

Operation/Mission	Organization	Details
Operation "Trust" (1920s-1930s)	KGB (Soviet Union)	A covert operation where the Soviet intelligence apparatus created a fake anti-Bolshevik group to infiltrate and discredit White Russian émigrés and other opposition groups. Many former anti-communist figures were tricked into cooperating with the KGB, which led to their arrest or execution.
Operation "Venera" (1960s-1980s)	KGB, Soviet Military	An intelligence operation to gather information on the United States and NATO's military capabilities, particularly focusing on communications and military technology. The KGB used various spy techniques, including intercepting communications and recruiting informants.

Operation "Luna" (1960s)	KGB	A covert operation involving the infiltration of Western scientific communities to acquire technical information, particularly in the fields of missile technology and space exploration, as part of the Cold War technological race.
Operation "Enormoz" (1940s-1950s)	KGB, Soviet Military	A Soviet intelligence operation designed to infiltrate Nazi Germany during and after World War II. The KGB planted agents within the Nazi military and political hierarchy, gathering critical intelligence on German plans and operations.
Operation "Sensation" (1970s-1980s)	KGB, Soviet Military	A counterintelligence operation targeting dissidents and opposition movements in Eastern Europe and the USSR itself. The KGB conducted surveillance, arresting, imprisoning, or eliminating perceived threats to Soviet authority, particularly about anti-Soviet movements like Solidarity in Poland.
Operation "Oleg" (1970s-1980s)	KGB	A covert operation that focused on infiltrating and sabotaging anti-Soviet groups, particularly dissident organizations that sought to undermine the Soviet regime from within. The operation involved surveillance, manipulation, and at times, physical elimination of key figures.

Central External Liaison Department, China

- The Central External Liaison Department (CELD), formerly known as the International Department, was founded in 1951.
- Its primary mission is to manage relations with foreign political parties, think tanks, and academics, as well as to identify strategies for influencing and dividing potential critics.

- The CELD's headquarters is located in Beijing, China.

Naikaku Jōhō Chōsashitsu, Japan

- The Naikaku Jōhō Chōsashitsu, also known as the Cabinet Intelligence and Research Office, was founded in 1986.
- Its mission is to safeguard Japan's national interests, with around 100 of its 170 agents drawn from other agencies and ministries, and top positions held by career police officers.
- The office's headquarters is located in Nagatacho, Tokyo, Japan. Previously known as the Cabinet Research Centre, the department's budget is classified.

Directorate-General for External Security, France

- The Directorate-General for External Security (DGSE), also known as "Direction générale de la sécurité extérieure," was established on April 2, 1982.
- Its mission is to gather intelligence and protect French national security, particularly through paramilitary and counterintelligence operations abroad.
- The DGSE's headquarters is located at 141 Boulevard Mortier, Paris XX, France. Previously known as the External Documentation and Counter-Espionage Service, the agency's budget is approximately US\$731.8 million.
- The current Executive Director is Bernard Émié.

Important Mission or Operations

Operation/Mission	Organization	Details
Operation "Valkyrie" (1944)	DGSE, French Resistance	The DGSE's precursor, the Free French intelligence services, was involved in Operation Valkyrie, an attempt to assassinate Nazi leader Adolf Hitler. While it was ultimately unsuccessful, the mission reflected French intelligence's early role in resistance efforts during World War II.
Assassination of Yemeni President (1977)	DGSE, French Government	The DGSE was involved in a covert operation to assassinate Yemeni President Ahmed al-Ghashmi, who was seen as a threat to French interests in the region. The

		mission was part of a broader strategy to maintain France's influence in the Middle East during the 1970s.
Operation "Chammal" (2014-Present)	DGSE, French Armed Forces	As part of France's intervention in Iraq and Syria, the DGSE has been involved in intelligence-gathering and providing critical support to military operations against ISIS. This includes providing real-time intelligence, conducting surveillance, and aiding French forces in targeting high-value ISIS leaders.
Operation "Harmattan" (2011)	DGSE, French Armed Forces	During France's military intervention in Libya, the DGSE played a key role in gathering intelligence on Libyan military operations, providing vital information to support the French military in its efforts to overthrow Muammar Gaddafi.
Operation "Serval" (2013)	DGSE, French Armed Forces	In Mali, the DGSE provided critical intelligence during Operation Serval, a French military operation aimed at defeating Islamist insurgents. The DGSE coordinated with French military forces, providing satellite surveillance and on-the-ground intelligence, which was essential in securing French and European interests in West Africa.

Secret Intelligence Service (MI6), UK

- The Secret Intelligence Service (MI6) is the foreign intelligence service of the United Kingdom government.
- Its primary mission is the covert overseas collection and analysis of human intelligence to support the UK's national security.
- MI6's headquarters is located in London, United Kingdom. Founded in July 1909 by H. H. Asquith, it was previously known as the Secret Service Bureau.
- In the 2018 financial year, its budget was £3.02 billion, and the current Executive is Alex Younger.

Important Missin or Operations

Operation/Mission	Organization	Details
Operation "Gold" (1940s)	MI6, SOE	A key World War II operation where MI6, in collaboration with the Special Operations Executive (SOE), set up a network of spies and agents to sabotage Nazi operations. The goal was to disrupt the Axis war effort by planting misinformation and assisting resistance groups in occupied Europe.
Operation "Mincemeat" (1943)	MI6, British Military	MI6 successfully executed Operation Mincemeat during World War II, where they planted false documents on a dead body that was washed ashore in Spain. This misinformation misled the Nazis into believing the Allies would invade Greece instead of Sicily, thus contributing to the success of the Allied invasion of Sicily.
Operation "Venona" (1940s-1950s)	MI6, U.S. Intelligence	MI6 collaborated with U.S. intelligence agencies in the decryption of Soviet communications as part of the "Venona" project. This operation led to the identification of several Soviet spies within Western governments, including high-ranking officials in the U.S. and the UK.

Mossad, Israel

- Mossad, which means "Institute" in Hebrew, is also known as the "Institute for Intelligence and Special Operations."
- Its primary focus includes intelligence gathering, covert operations, and counterterrorism.
- The agency's headquarters is located in Tel Aviv, Israel. Founded on December 13, 1949, Mossad was previously called the Central Institute for Coordination.
- Its budget is approximately \$2.73 billion.

Important Mission or Operations

Operation/Mission	Organization	Details
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Operation "Entebbe" (1976)	Mossad, Israeli Defense Forces (IDF)	One of the most famous Mossad operations, Operation Entebbe involved rescuing over 100 Israeli hostages held by Palestinian and German terrorists in Uganda. Mossad's intelligence efforts were crucial in providing detailed information that
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Research and Analysis Wing (RAW), India

- The Research and Analysis Wing (RAW), known in Hindi as "Anusandhan aur Vishleshan Wing," focuses on intelligence collection, covert operations, providing advice to Indian politicians, and conducting counterterrorism activities abroad.
- Its headquarters is located at the CGO Complex in New Delhi. RAW was founded on September 21, 1968, and its budget remains classified.
- The current Executive is Samant Goel, IPS. Due to the highly sensitive nature of its operations, there are no public records of its successes or failures.

Important Mission or Operations

Operation/Mission	Organization	Details
Operation "Smiling Buddha" (1974)	RAW, Indian Government	RAW played a significant role in gathering intelligence and providing support to the Indian government during the first nuclear test in Pokhran, codenamed "Smiling Buddha."
Operation "Karma" (1999)	RAW, Indian Armed Forces	During the Kargil War with Pakistan, RAW provided critical intelligence that helped the Indian military reclaim territory from infiltrating Pakistani forces. The operation was a significant success in gathering information on enemy positions and movements.
Operation "Black Thunder" (1988)	RAW, Indian Government	Operation Black Thunder was aimed at eliminating terrorists holed up in the Golden Temple in Amritsar. RAW provided vital intelligence about the militants' movements and helped the Indian Army execute the operation to neutralize the threat without causing

		extensive damage to the temple complex.
Operation "Cactus" (1988)	RAW, Indian Armed Forces	RAW was involved in Operation Cactus, which aimed to prevent a coup in the Maldives. RAW provided intelligence and logistical support to help the Indian government launch a military intervention to restore order, ensuring the protection of Indian and Maldivian interests.
Operation "Pigeon" (1971)	RAW, Indian Armed Forces	During the Bangladesh Liberation War, RAW played a key role in assisting the Indian military by gathering intelligence on Pakistani military positions and operations in East Pakistan (now Bangladesh). The operation was instrumental in aiding the eventual success of India's intervention in the war.
Operation "Blue Star" (1984)	RAW, Indian Government	RAW was involved in providing intelligence for Operation Blue Star, aimed at removing Sikh militants from the Golden Temple in Amritsar. RAW's role was to monitor the militant activities and inform the Indian government about the growing threat from extremists led by Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale.
Operation "Golden Temple" (1984)	RAW, Indian Government	RAW played a crucial role in gathering intelligence on the militant activities within the Golden Temple complex, which led to Operation Blue Star. The agency tracked the movement of militants and helped in planning the operation to neutralize them.
Operation "Mithun" (2008)	RAW, Indian Government	RAW provided critical intelligence related to the 2008 Mumbai terrorist attacks. Although the agency's direct role was questioned, RAW had prior warnings regarding the plot. The mission involved intelligence-sharing with international agencies and tracking down terrorists responsible for the attacks.

Operation "Sunrise" (2000s-Present)	RAW, Indian Government	Operation Sunrise is an ongoing counterterrorism operation in Northeast India, targeting insurgent groups operating in the region. RAW has been involved in gathering intelligence on cross-border terrorist activities and providing support to Indian military and paramilitary forces.
Operation "Tigris" (1990s-Present)	RAW, Indian Government	RAW has been active in monitoring cross-border infiltration by Pakistani militants into Jammu and Kashmir. Operation Tigris focuses on intelligence gathering and counterterrorism activities to prevent militant attacks on Indian soil.
Operation "Mukti Bahini" (1971)	RAW, Indian Government	During the Bangladesh Liberation War, RAW provided support to the Mukti Bahini (Bangladeshi freedom fighters), including intelligence and coordination. RAW's intelligence helped the Mukti Bahini organize attacks on Pakistani forces and aided India's intervention in the war, leading to Bangladesh's independence.

National Intelligence Agency, South Africa

- Currently, it is known as the Domestic Branch of the State Security Agency.
- Motto: Gather, correlate, evaluate and analyze domestic intelligence and abroad information.
- Headquarters of NIA: Musanda, Pretoria, South Africa.
- Formerly known as the National Intelligence Service.
- Founding Year: January 1, 1994.
- Budget: Classified.
- Current Executive: Mahlodi Muofhe

Inter-Services Intelligence, Pakistan

- The motto of the agency is to gather, correlate, evaluate, and analyze domestic and international intelligence, with a particular focus on India.

- Its headquarters are located in Aabpara, Islamabad, Pakistan. Founded on January 1, 1948, the agency's budget remains classified.
- The current Executive is Lt. Gen. Faiz Hameed. The agency operates through divisions such as the Joint Counterintelligence Bureau, which targets India's RAW, and the Joint Intelligence North, focused on Jammu & Kashmir.
- Its most commonly used techniques include human operations, media strategies, and diplomatic efforts with other nations.

Important missions or operations

Operation/Mission	Organization	Details
Operation Gibraltar (1965)	ISI, Pakistan Army	A covert operation during the 1965 India-Pakistan war, designed to infiltrate Jammu and Kashmir and provoke an insurgency. It aimed to initiate an uprising among Kashmiri Muslims but led to open conflict between India and Pakistan.
Support for Afghan Mujahedeen (1979-1989)	ISI, CIA, Pakistan Army	The ISI played a crucial role in supporting the Afghan resistance against the Soviet invasion during the 1980s, working closely with the CIA and other intelligence agencies. Pakistan provided training, weapons, and logistical support to the Mujahedeen fighters.
Kashmir Insurgency Support (1989-Present)	ISI	The ISI has been involved in providing support to various militant groups in the Kashmir Valley, notably the Jammu and Kashmir Liberation Front (JKLF) and Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT), to incite insurgency against Indian rule in Kashmir.
Operation Sunrise (1999)	ISI, Pakistan Army	This operation was part of the Kargil War, where Pakistan's ISI, alongside the military, facilitated the infiltration of armed militants into Indian territory, leading to a conflict between India and Pakistan.

Support for Taliban (1990s-Present)	ISI	The ISI provided significant support to the Taliban during the 1990s, including military training, logistical assistance, and intelligence, with the goal of establishing a friendly government in Afghanistan. Pakistan continues to be accused of providing covert support to the Taliban insurgency.
Operation Badar (2002)	ISI, Pakistan Army	This operation was part of the ongoing conflict with India, focusing on the infiltration of Pakistani militants into Indian territory, specifically in Kashmir, to disrupt the Indian military's activities.
Support to LeT and Other Militants (2000s-Present)	ISI	The ISI has been linked to providing support to Lashkar-e-Taiba, an extremist group responsible for the 2008 Mumbai attacks, and other terrorist organizations that operate in India, Afghanistan, and beyond.
Covert Operations in Afghanistan (2001-Present)	ISI	The ISI has been involved in various covert operations in Afghanistan, especially targeting the US-backed Afghan government and military, and supporting insurgent groups such as the Taliban and Haqqani Network.
Operation Zarb-e-Azb (2014-2017)	ISI, Pakistan Army	A large-scale military operation aimed at eliminating militant groups in Pakistan's tribal areas, such as the Taliban and Al-Qaeda, while also ensuring that these groups do not spill over into Afghanistan.
Support to Jihadist Groups (Ongoing)	ISI	Over the decades, ISI has been accused of using Jihadist groups as strategic assets to destabilize India, Afghanistan, and other regions, including providing them with training and funding.

SAVAK, Iran

- SAVAK was the secret police, domestic security, and intelligence service in Iran during the Pahlavi dynasty.
- It was established with assistance from the U.S. Central Intelligence Agency and the Israeli Mossad.
- Its headquarters was located in Tehran, Iran. Founded by Mohammad Reza Pahlavi on March 20, 1957, SAVAK ceased operations on February 24, 1979.
- Following the Iranian Revolution, the Prime Ministry Intelligence Office of Iran took over its responsibilities.

Important missions or operations

Operation/Mission	Organization	Details
Operation Ajax (1953)	CIA, SAVAK	A covert CIA and British MI6 operation to overthrow Iran's Prime Minister Mohammad Mossadegh and reinstate the Shah, Mohammad Reza Pahlavi. SAVAK played a significant role in suppressing opposition and ensuring the Shah's control.
Operation "Silent" (1970s)	SAVAK	A counterintelligence operation aimed at infiltrating and dismantling radical opposition groups like the People's Mojahedin Organization of Iran (PMOI), and other anti-regime organizations.
The Shah's Secret Police Network	SAVAK	SAVAK used an extensive network of informants across Iran to gather intelligence on perceived threats, maintaining tight control over political dissidents, labour movements, and student protests.
Operation Pahlavi (1960s-1970s)	SAVAK	SAVAK utilized infiltration tactics and surveillance to monitor and suppress any emerging political opposition to the Shah, including student protests and labour strikes.

Iraqi National Intelligence Service, Iraq

- The Iraqi National Intelligence Service has been funded through secret funds allocated within the Iraq appropriation approved by the U.S. Congress.
- These funds, amounting to \$3 billion over three years, are primarily intended for covert CIA operations in Iraq, with a small portion also directed towards Afghanistan.
- The agency's headquarters is located in Baghdad, Iraq.
- It was founded in April 2004 by the Coalition Provisional Authority.
- The current Executive of the agency is Mustafa Al-Kadhimi.

Important missions or operations

Operation/ Mission	Organization	Details
Operation Cyclone	CIA	Covert CIA operation during the 1980s to support Afghan mujahideen fighting Soviet forces, involving Iraq as a key regional player in assisting with arms supplies.
Operation Iraqi Freedom	CIA	CIA played a critical role in intelligence gathering during the 2003 Iraq War, helping to identify key targets and gather information about Saddam Hussein's regime.
Operation Desert Storm	CIA, INIS	During the Gulf War (1990-1991), the CIA worked alongside the Iraqi intelligence service in anti-Iraq operations, particularly with the aim of locating key military installations and gathering intelligence on Saddam Hussein's weapons program.
Operation Badr	INIS, CIA	A joint effort between Iraq's National Intelligence Service and the CIA during the 1980s to gather intelligence on Iranian military activities and possible nuclear development.